HACK876 × SANDALS FOUNDATION

PRIVATE EXPLORATORY BRIEF

Let the learning continue after the demo.

The Sandals Foundation looks for lasting benefit, not a single day. We would like to introduce Hack876 and ask whether what happens after the event could ever be a fit.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80
STUDENTS

9
SCHOOL NETWORK

1
DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

01 WHAT IS HACK876?

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Digital learning that lasts longer than a day.

Hack876 is one day. The question we want to ask is what could stay with students and schools afterwards.

Education is one of the Foundation's strategic focus areas, covering school infrastructure, teacher training, digital literacy and scholarships.[1]

In 2021 the Foundation and Rainforest delivered some fifty digital tablets to students at St Mary Primary School in Above Rocks, St. Catherine.[2]

Its Lessons Alive campaign, from August 2020, raised funds for digital tablets for vulnerable primary school students.[2]

Devices in students' hands, and a clear process for what comes next.

AUGUST 2020

Lessons Alive.

A campaign that raised funds to buy and distribute digital tablets to vulnerable primary school students.[2]

DECEMBER 2021

Fifty tablets in Above Rocks.

Delivered with Rainforest to students aged 6 to 12 at St Mary Primary School, based on a needs assessment.[2]

2027 PROJECTS

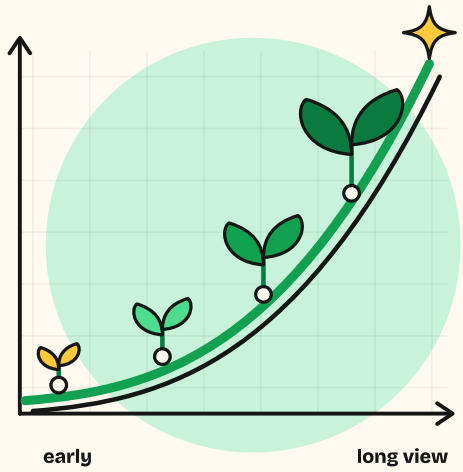
A two-stage process.

Concept applications were open from July 6 to 27, 2026. Full proposals are by invitation only.[1]

GUIDELINES

Long-term benefit is required.

Projects must include measurable outcomes and long-term benefit. One-off events without sustainable impact are not funded.[1]



We have read the guidelines. A one-day event on its own does not meet them, and we are not asking for an exception.

9 schools. One room.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

Whether there is a route that suits the Sandals Foundation.

The Foundation takes enquiries through the contact page on its website.[3]

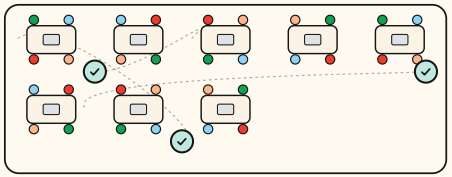
TO EXPLORE

Is there a suitable route, now or later?

- A future cycle, if the lasting part of the work fits
- Resources schools could reuse after the day
- Mentoring that continues after the event
- Or simply an introduction, with nothing asked

If there is a fit, it does not have to be financial.

People in the room.



01

A guest at the finals

Someone from the Foundation is welcome to watch the final pitches and meet the students.

02

Advice

Guidance on what lasting benefit would need to look like for work of this kind.

03

An introduction

If another organisation is a better home for this, we would be glad to be pointed to it.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing to students and no sign-ups on the day.

No collection of student contact details by partners. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

An introduction, and a conversation about fit.

A conversation

NO FUNDING REQUEST IN THIS BRIEF

We would like the Foundation to know Hack876 exists, and to hear honestly whether the part that continues after the day could ever fit its work.

This brief is not an application and does not assume Hack876 is eligible for funding. It asks whether a suitable route exists.

WHAT WE WOULD LIKE TO ASK

- ✓ Is there a future or alternative route that could suit work like this?
- ✓ Would reusable school resources be closer to what the Foundation supports?
- ✓ Would follow-up mentoring count as lasting benefit?
- ✓ Who is the right person to speak with, and when?

08 WHAT WE COULD DISCUSS

Ideas to explore, not a request.

AREAS A CONVERSATION COULD COVER

- **Materials.** Learning materials students and schools can keep using.
- **Equipment.** The equipment teams build with, and what happens to it afterwards.
- **Programming.** Mentoring and the student programme, on the day and after it.

These are ideas to explore. None of them is an agreed activity or a funding request.

WHAT WE UNDERSTAND FROM THE PUBLISHED GUIDELINES

The 2027 guidelines require legally registered organisations and long-term benefit. They exclude one-off events without sustainable impact, and sponsorships or prizes without broader community benefit. The concept window closed on July 27, 2026. We do not assume Hack876 is eligible, and this is not a late submission.

09 A DIRECT LINE

We would rather ask than assume.

This brief is for **the Sandals Foundation team**.[3]

If the Sandals Foundation sees a possible fit, we would welcome guidance on the right route and timing. If not, thank you for reading.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Could the follow-up to an event like this ever meet the guidelines?
- ✓ Would it need to come through a school or a registered organisation?
- ✓ When is the next concept window likely to open?
- ✓ When and where is Hack876?
- ✓ How are students protected on consent, data and marketing?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Start with a conversation.

No funding or commitment is being requested.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- Resources from the day that schools could reuse in class.
- Follow-up mentoring for teams after the event.
- A concept application in a future cycle, if the work fits and Hack876 is eligible.



HACK876 × SANDALS FOUNDATION

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would welcome a conversation with the Sandals Foundation team, whatever the answer turns out to be.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. Sandals Foundation, "Sandals Foundation 2027 Project Guidelines & Selection Criteria (July 2026)." sandalsfoundation.org/news/sandals-foundation-2027-project-guidelines-and-selection-criteria

2. Sandals Foundation, "Sandals Foundation and Rainforest Open A New World of Learning for Vulnerable Primary School Students (December 2021)." sandalsfoundation.org/news/sandals-foundation-and-rainforest-open-a-new-world-of-learning-for-vulnerable-primary-school-students

3. Sandals Foundation, "Contact." sandalsfoundation.org/contact

A private exploratory brief prepared for the team at the Sandals Foundation.